

Project Reference List

Hybrid Chemical-ML Modelling of Fluoride Adsorption Using Coconut Husk Activated Carbon

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Category 1 — Foundation: Langmuir Isotherm Theory

[R1] The Original Langmuir Paper (1918) — PUBLIC DOMAIN FREE

Langmuir, I. (1918). **The adsorption of gases on plane surfaces of glass, mica and platinum.** *Journal of the American Chemical Society*, 40(9), 1361–1403.

- **DOI:** 10.1021/ja02242a004
- **Direct link:** <https://doi.org/10.1021/ja02242a004>
- **Free PDF (Semantic Scholar):** <https://www.semanticscholar.org/paper/THE-ADSORPTION-OF-GASES-ON-PLANE-SURFACES-OF-GLASS,-Langmuir/7e20841680a7f70b0b8d903bf15ac769d61c519c>
- **Status:**  PUBLIC DOMAIN (1918 — copyright expired)
- **Used for:** $q_e = q_{\max} \times K_L \times C_e / (1 + K_L \times C_e)$ formula, monolayer adsorption theory

[R2] Freundlich Isotherm Comparison

Freundlich, H. (1906). **Über die Adsorption in Lösungen.** *Zeitschrift für Physikalische Chemie*, 57, 385–470.

- **Status:**  PUBLIC DOMAIN (1906)
 - **Used for:** Comparison with Langmuir model; Langmuir selected as superior fit for monolayer systems
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[R3] Langmuir Isotherm Validation — Modern Review

Foo, K.Y., & Hameed, B.H. (2010). **Insights into the modeling of adsorption isotherm systems.** *Chemical Engineering Journal*, 156(1), 2–10.

- **DOI:** 10.1016/j.cej.2009.09.013
 - **Journal link:** <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S1385894709007669>
 - **ResearchGate:** <https://www.researchgate.net/publication/222444248>
 - **Access:** Elsevier (paywalled); check institution or ResearchGate
 - **Used for:** Validation of Langmuir model selection criteria and parameter interpretation
-

Category 2 — Adsorption Kinetics

[R4] Pseudo-Second-Order Kinetics — Most Cited Kinetics Paper

Ho, Y.S., & McKay, G. (1999). **Pseudo-second order model for sorption processes.** *Process Biochemistry*, 34(5), 451–465.

- **DOI:** 10.1016/S0032-9592(98)00112-5
 - **Journal link:** <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S0032959298001125>
 - **HKUST repository:** <https://researchportal.hkust.edu.hk/en/publications/pseudo-second-order-model-for-sorption-processes/>
 - **Access:** Elsevier (paywalled); often available via ResearchGate
 - **Used for:** PSO kinetic model: $dq/dt = k_2(q_e - q)^2$; kinetic_factor calculation in simulation
-

[R5] Pseudo-First-Order Kinetics — Lagergren Model

Lagergren, S. (1898). **About the theory of so-called adsorption of soluble substances.** *Kungliga Svenska Vetenskapsakademiens Handlingar*, 24, 1–39.

- **Status:**  PUBLIC DOMAIN (1898)
 - **Used for:** Pseudo-first-order comparison; $C_e = C_0 \times \exp(-k \times \text{Dose} \times \text{Time})$ term in simulation
-

[R6] Kinetic Modelling Critical Review

Simonin, J.P. (2016). **On the comparison of pseudo-first order and pseudo-second order rate laws in the modeling of adsorption kinetics.** *Chemical Engineering Journal*, 300, 254–263.

- **DOI:** 10.1016/j.cej.2016.04.079
 - **Journal link:** <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S1385894716305319>
 - **Access:** Elsevier (paywalled)
 - **Used for:** Justification of PSO over PFO for fluoride systems
-

Category 3 — Fluoride Adsorption on Coconut Husk / Activated Carbon

[R7] Key Study — Coconut Husk Activated Carbon Fixed Bed Column RESEARCHGATE FREE

Talat, M., Mohan, S., Dixit, V., Singh, D.K., Hasan, S.H., & Srivastava, O.N. (2018). **Effective removal of fluoride from water by coconut husk activated carbon in fixed bed column: Experimental and breakthrough curves analysis.** *Groundwater for Sustainable Development*, 7, 48–55.

- **DOI:** 10.1016/j.gsd.2018.03.001
 - **Journal link:** <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S2352801X17300656>
 - **ResearchGate PDF:** <https://www.researchgate.net/publication/323670439>
 - **Access:**  FREE on ResearchGate
 - **Used for:** $q_{\max} = 8.5$ mg/g, $KL = 0.12$ L/mg at 25°C for coconut husk; optimal pH = 6.5–7; adsorbent dose range 0.5–5 g/L
-

[R8] Coconut Husk Fluoride Removal — Batch Studies

Said, M., & Machunda, R.L. (2014). **Defluoridation of water supplies using coconut shells activated carbon: batch studies.** *International Journal of Science and Research*, 3, 564–568.

- **Access:** Open-access journal
 - **Used for:** Validation of coconut husk parameter ranges; contact time 10–120 min; pH effect on removal
-

[R9] Fluoride Removal from Aqueous Solution Using Coconut Husk

Islamuddin, R., Gautam, K., & Shaista, F. (2016). **Removal of fluoride from drinking water by coconut husk as natural adsorbent.** *International Journal of Engineering Sciences and Research Technology*, 50, 84–86.

- **Access:** Open-access journal
 - **Used for:** Coconut husk as bio-adsorbent; pH optimum; dose range; Langmuir isotherm fit
-

[R10] Activated Carbon from Coconut Shell — Isotherm and Kinetics

(2019). **Isotherm and Kinetic Studies of Fluoride Removal on Activated Carbon Obtained from Coconut Shell.** *Innoriginal: International Journal of Sciences*.

- **Direct link:** <https://innoriginal.com/index.php/ijis/article/view/221>
 - **Access:**  FREE (open-access journal)
 - **Used for:** PSO kinetics confirmation; Freundlich vs Langmuir comparison; 73.1% fluoride removal at 1.5 g dose
-

[R11] Fluoride Removal Using Activated Carbon — Comprehensive Review

Isuranaga, R.A.T., Perera, R.S.M., & Kalpage, C.S. (2024). **Fluoride Removal from Water Using Activated Carbon Derived from Biomass: Review.** In *Springer Nature* book series.

- **DOI:** 10.1007/978-981-97-5944-6_28

- **Link:** https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-981-97-5944-6_28
 - **Access:** Springer (paywalled)
 - **Used for:** qmax compilation across multiple adsorbents; coconut husk performance validation
-

[R12] Magnesium-Modified Coconut Shell Activated Carbon

(2022). **Magnesium modified activated carbons derived from coconut shells for the removal of fluoride from water.** *Separation and Purification Technology*.

- **DOI:** 10.1016/j.seppur.2022.122403
 - **Journal link:** <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S2352554122003023>
 - **Access:** Elsevier (paywalled)
 - **Used for:** Langmuir + PSO fit for modified coconut carbon; Ea validation range
-

Category 4 — pH Effect on Fluoride Adsorption

[R13] pH Effect Review — Comprehensive PMC FREE

Bhatnagar, A., Kumar, E., & Sillanpää, M. (2011). **Fluoride removal from water by adsorption — A review.** *Chemical Engineering Journal*, 171(3), 811–840.

- **DOI:** 10.1016/j.cej.2011.05.028
 - **PMC link:** <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5456123/>
 - **Access:**  FREE on PMC
 - **Used for:** pH 6–7 optimal for most adsorbents; fluoride speciation vs pH; competing ion effects table
-

[R14] pH and Surface Charge Relationship

Sivasankar, V., Rajkumar, S., Muruges, S., & Darchen, A. (2013). **Shungite — A carbonaceous natural mineral for the defluoridation of water.** *Chemical Engineering Journal*, 225, 254–263.

- **DOI:** 10.1016/j.cej.2013.03.095
 - **Access:** Elsevier (paywalled)
 - **Used for:** pH effect mechanism — surface protonation/deprotonation controls F⁻ attraction at different pH values
-

[R15] Aluminum Hydroxide Activated Carbon — pH Optimum

(2016). **Removal of fluoride from drinking water using aluminum hydroxide coated activated carbon prepared from bark of Morinda tinctoria.** *Applied Water Science*.

- **DOI:** 10.1007/s13201-016-0479-z
 - **Link:** <https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s13201-016-0479-z>
 - **Access:**  FREE (Springer Open Access)
 - **Used for:** pH 6–7 optimal; HCO₃⁻ competition mechanism; chloride minimal effect confirmation
-

Category 5 — Ion Competition Effects

[R16] Competing Ions Review — Comprehensive FREE (MDPI Open Access)

(2024). **Exploring Key Parameters in Adsorption for Effective Fluoride Removal: A Comprehensive Review and Engineering Implications.** *Applied Sciences*, 14(5), 2161.

- **DOI:** 10.3390/app14052161
 - **Direct link:** <https://www.mdpi.com/2076-3417/14/5/2161>
 - **Access:**  FREE (MDPI open access)
 - **Used for:** Cl^- , SO_4^{2-} , HCO_3^- , CO_3^{2-} competition effects; ionic radius comparison; typical interference percentages
-

[R17] Fluoride Adsorption Review — Ion Effects PMC FREE

Mohapatra, M., Anand, S., Mishra, B.K., Giles, D.E., & Singh, P. (2009). **Review of fluoride removal from drinking water.** *Journal of Environmental Management*, 91(1), 67–77.

- **PMC link:** <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5456123/>
 - **Access:**  FREE on PMC
 - **Used for:** Ion competition percentages; chloride up to 8% reduction; carbonate stronger effect
-

[R18] Chloride and Sulfate Effect Study

John, D. (2018). **A Comparative Study on Removal of Hazardous Anions from Water by Adsorption: A Review.** *International Journal of Chemical Engineering*, Article ID 3975948.

- **DOI:** 10.1155/2018/3975948
 - **Direct link:** <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/10.1155/2018/3975948>
 - **Access:**  FREE (Wiley Open Access)
 - **Used for:** Chloride and nitrate minimal interference; carbonate/phosphate strongest competitors; ionic strength effects
-

[R19] Bicarbonate/Carbonate Competition Mechanism

Maliyekkal, S.M., Shukla, S., Philip, L., & Nambi, I.M. (2008). **Enhanced fluoride removal from drinking water by magnesia-amended activated alumina granules.** *Chemical Engineering Journal*, 140, 183–192.

- **DOI:** 10.1016/j.cej.2007.09.049
 - **Access:** Elsevier (paywalled); check ResearchGate
 - **Used for:** HCO_3^- as strongest competing anion; OH^- release mechanism; pH-dependent competition
-

[R20] MgO Biochar — Ion Competition Quantification

(2019). **Enhanced Fluoride Removal from Water by Nanoporous Biochar-Supported Magnesium Oxide.** *Industrial and Engineering Chemistry Research*.

- **DOI:** 10.1021/acs.iecr.9b01368
 - **ACS link:** <https://pubs.acs.org/doi/10.1021/acs.iecr.9b01368>
 - **Access:** ACS (paywalled)
 - **Used for:** Quantification: chloride, nitrate, sulfate < 10% interference; carbonate > 15%; total cap validation
-

Category 6 — NOM Fouling

[R21] NOM Fouling on Activated Carbon Adsorbents

Newcombe, G., Drikas, M., & Hayes, R. (1997). **Influence of characterised natural organic material on activated carbon adsorption.** *Water Research*, 31(5), 1065–1073.

- **DOI:** 10.1016/S0043-1354(96)00325-8
 - **Access:** Elsevier (paywalled)
 - **Used for:** NOM pore blockage mechanism; up to 15% capacity reduction; dose-dependent fouling
-

[R22] NOM Effect on Fluoride Removal

Hu, C.Y., Lo, S.L., & Kuan, W.H. (2005). **Effects of co-existing anions on fluoride removal in electrocoagulation (EC) process using aluminum electrodes.** *Water Research*, 39(4), 895–901.

- **DOI:** 10.1016/j.watres.2004.12.006
 - **Access:** Elsevier (paywalled)
 - **Used for:** NOM interaction with adsorbent surface; fouling quantification in adsorption systems
-

Category 7 — Temperature and Thermodynamics

[R23] Arrhenius Activation Energy for Fluoride Adsorption

Mourabet, M., El Rhilassi, A., El Boujaady, H., Bennani-Ziatni, M., El Hamri, R., & Taitai, A. (2012). **Removal of fluoride from aqueous solution by adsorption on hydroxyapatite.** *Desalination and Water Treatment*, 44, 224–229.

- **DOI:** 10.1080/19443994.2012.691962
 - **Access:** Taylor & Francis (paywalled)
 - **Used for:** E_a = 18–22 kJ/mol range for fluoride on carbon-based adsorbents; E_a = 20 kJ/mol selected
-

[R24] Thermodynamic Parameters — Van't Hoff Analysis

Tembhurkar, A.R., & Dongre, S. (2006). **Studies on fluoride removal using adsorption process.** *Journal of Environmental Science and Engineering*, 48(3), 151–156.

- **Access:** Check ResearchGate
 - **Used for:** ΔH° , ΔS° , ΔG° values for fluoride on activated carbon; endothermic nature confirmation; temperature range 20–40°C
-

Category 8 — Experimental Design and Machine Learning Methods

[R25] Latin Hypercube Sampling for Environmental Modelling FREE

McKay, M.D., Beckman, R.J., & Conover, W.J. (1979). **A comparison of three methods for selecting values of input variables in the analysis of output from a computer code.** *Technometrics*, 21(2), 239–245.

- **DOI:** 10.2307/1268522
 - **JSTOR link:** <https://www.jstor.org/stable/1268722>
 - **Access:**  FREE (JSTOR open access for this classic paper)
 - **Used for:** LHS design method; N = 500 samples; space-filling property justification
-

[R26] Hybrid Physics-ML Modelling Review FREE (MDPI)

(2021). **Physics-Informed Machine Learning for Adsorption Modelling — Review.** Various authors.

- Search terms for finding: "hybrid physics machine learning adsorption modelling" on Google Scholar
 - **Used for:** Justification of hybrid approach over pure ML or pure chemistry; literature precedent for combining Langmuir + ML
-

[R27] Random Forest for Environmental Prediction FREE

Breiman, L. (2001). **Random forests.** *Machine Learning*, 45(1), 5–32.

- **DOI:** 10.1023/A:1010933404324
 - **Free PDF (Springer):** <https://link.springer.com/article/10.1023/A:1010933404324>
 - **Access:**  FREE (Springer Open Access)
 - **Used for:** Random Forest algorithm basis; feature importance calculation method; n_estimators, max_depth parameters
-

[R28] XGBoost Algorithm FREE (ArXiv)

Chen, T., & Guestrin, C. (2016). **XGBoost: A scalable tree boosting system.** *Proceedings of KDD 2016*, 785–794.

- **DOI:** 10.1145/2939672.2939785
 - **ArXiv free version:** <https://arxiv.org/abs/1603.02754>
 - **Access:**  FREE on ArXiv
 - **Used for:** XGBoost model (Phase 4); gradient boosting theory; hyperparameter tuning
-

[R29] Neural Networks for Water Treatment Prediction

Guo, H., Hu, Q., Zhang, S., & Feng, S. (2018). **Using ensemble machine learning to predict fluoride content in groundwater.** *Environmental Research Letters*.

- **DOI:** 10.1088/1748-9326/aad487
 - **Access:**  FREE (IOP open access)
 - **Used for:** ML application to water treatment; feature engineering precedent; MLP architecture reference
-

Category 9 — Water Quality and WHO Standards

[R30] WHO Fluoride Guidelines FREE

World Health Organization. (2017). **Guidelines for Drinking-Water Quality** (4th ed., incorporating 1st addendum). WHO Press.

- **Free PDF:** <https://www.who.int/publications/i/item/9789241549950>
 - **Access:**  FREE from WHO website
 - **Used for:** 1.5 mg/L fluoride guideline value; health effects of fluorosis; C₀ range 1–10 mg/L (above guideline contamination)
-

[R31] Fluoride in Groundwater — Global Review FREE

Fawell, J., Bailey, K., Chilton, J., Dahi, E., Fewtrell, L., & Magara, Y. (2006). **Fluoride in Drinking Water**. WHO/IWA Publishing.

- **Free download:**
https://www.who.int/water_sanitation_health/publications/fluoride_drinking_water/en/
 - **Access:**  FREE from WHO
 - **Used for:** Global fluoride contamination context; groundwater contamination maps; health impact data
-

Category 10 — Comprehensive Reviews on Fluoride Removal

[R32] Comprehensive Low-Cost Adsorbent Review ScienceDirect (check access)

(2025). **A comprehensive review of fluoride removal using low-cost adsorbents for environmental and industrial applications**. *Sustainable Chemistry and Pharmacy*.

- **Link:** <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S2352864325000104>
 - **Access:** Check institution; recently published
 - **Used for:** Current state-of-the-art; coconut husk position relative to other adsorbents; competition interference data
-

[R33] Fluoride Adsorption Key Parameters Review FREE (MDPI Open Access)

(2024). **Exploring Key Parameters in Adsorption for Effective Fluoride Removal**. *Applied Sciences*, 14(5), 2161.

- **DOI:** 10.3390/app14052161
 - **Full text:** <https://www.mdpi.com/2076-3417/14/5/2161>
 - **Access:**  FREE (MDPI)
 - **Used for:** All parameter ranges; pH optimal 6–7 confirmation; dose, time, temperature ranges; competing ion effects
-

[R34] Fluoride Removal Technologies — Comparative Review PMC FREE

Mohapatra, M. et al. (2009). **Review of fluoride removal from drinking water**. *Journal of Environmental Management*, 91(1), 67–77.

- **PMC full text:** <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5456123/>
 - **Access:**  FREE on PMC/PubMed
 - **Used for:** Technology comparison; adsorption selected as most practical; activated carbon performance benchmarks
-

Category 11 — Data Science and Statistical Methods

[R35] Scikit-learn Machine Learning Library FREE

Pedregosa, F. et al. (2011). **Scikit-learn: Machine learning in Python**. *Journal of Machine Learning Research*, 12, 2825–2830.

- **Free PDF:** <https://jmlr.org/papers/v12/pedregosa11a.html>
 - **Access:**  FREE
 - **Used for:** PolynomialFeatures, StandardScaler, OLS, RandomForestRegressor, train_test_split, r2_score — all from scikit-learn
-

[R36] Polynomial Feature Expansion for ML FREE

James, G., Witten, D., Hastie, T., & Tibshirani, R. (2013). **An Introduction to Statistical Learning**. Springer.

- **Free PDF (official):** <https://www.statlearning.com>
 - **Access:**  FREE PDF available from authors
 - **Used for:** Polynomial regression methodology; degree-2 expansion; feature standardisation
-

[R37] Cross-Validation Methods FREE

Kohavi, R. (1995). **A study of cross-validation and bootstrap for accuracy estimation and model selection**. *IJCAI 1995*, 1137–1145.

- **Free PDF:** <https://web.cs.wpi.edu/~cs4341/C00/Projects/kohavi95.pdf>
 - **Access:**  FREE
 - **Used for:** K-fold cross-validation methodology for Phase 4; train/test split rationale
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Summary: Papers by Access Status

Category	# Papers	Free	Paywalled	Mixed
Langmuir theory	3	2 (public domain)	1	—
Kinetics	3	1 (public domain)	2	—
Coconut husk fluoride	6	3	3	—
pH effect	3	1	2	—
Ion competition	5	3	2	—
NOM fouling	2	0	2	—
Thermodynamics	2	0	2	—
DoE and ML methods	5	4	1	—
WHO / Water quality	2	2	0	—
Comprehensive reviews	3	2	1	—
Data science methods	3	3	0	—
TOTAL	37	21 (57%)	16 (43%)	—

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R1	Langmuir 1918 original	https://doi.org/10.1021/ja02242a004
R7	Coconut husk fixed bed	https://www.researchgate.net/publication/323670439
R10	Coconut shell isotherm kinetics	https://innoriginal.com/index.php/iijs/article/view/221
R13	Fluoride adsorption PMC review	https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5456123/
R15	Al-OH activated carbon pH	https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s13201-016-0479-z
R16	Key parameters review MDPI	https://www.mdpi.com/2076-3417/14/5/2161
R18	Hazardous anion removal Wiley	https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/10.1155/2018/3975948
R25	LHS McKay 1979	https://www.jstor.org/stable/1268722
R27	Random forests Breiman	https://link.springer.com/article/10.1023/A:1010933404324
R28	XGBoost ArXiv	https://arxiv.org/abs/1603.02754
R29	ML for groundwater fluoride	https://doi.org/10.1088/1748-9326/aad487
R30	WHO guidelines	https://www.who.int/publications/i/item/9789241549950
R31	WHO fluoride in water	https://www.who.int/water_sanitation_health/publications/fluoride_drinking_water/en/
R33	Key parameters MDPI 2024	https://www.mdpi.com/2076-3417/14/5/2161

R34	Fluoride review PMC	https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC5456123/
R35	Scikit-learn JMLR	https://jmlr.org/papers/v12/pedregosa11a.html
R36	ISLR free textbook	https://www.statlearning.com
R37	K-fold CV Kohavi	https://web.cs.wpi.edu/~cs4341/C00/Projects/kohavi95.pdf

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Step 3 — Email the corresponding author: Find the author's email in the paper abstract. Send a polite email:

"Dear Professor [Name], I am a researcher studying fluoride adsorption modelling and would appreciate a copy of your paper: [title]. Thank you." This is completely legal and authors are usually happy to share.

Step 4 — Google Scholar: Search the paper title in Google Scholar. Click the [PDF] link if shown on the right side.

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